

CONFIDENTIAL · BUSINESS PLAN

The autonomous finance function for every UAE business.

Ledgr is an AI-native accounting, VAT and Corporate Tax platform purpose-built for the United Arab Emirates. It replaces the typical bookkeeping firm with autonomous agents — supervised by chartered accountants — and prices at a fraction of the incumbent cost.

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What's inside this document.

A complete operating blueprint for Ledgr — from market opportunity through three-year financial forecast, organisational design, and replication strategy across the GCC.

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— 01 — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A USD 1B+ category is being repriced by AI. We will own it in the UAE.

The UAE registered over **651,000 corporate tax entities** by September 2025. Each must now file VAT quarterly, Corporate Tax annually, comply with WPS payroll, and prepare for the mandatory **FTA e-invoicing mandate** rolling out from mid-2026. Today, this is delivered by traditional firms charging AED 1,500–8,000 per month and staffed by 3–8 junior accountants per book.

Ledgr replaces 80% of that headcount with AI agents, supervised by a small team of UAE-licensed chartered accountants. It delivers a faster, more accurate, fully digital service — at one-third of the incumbent price — and locks customers in through deep integrations with bank feeds, the FTA portal, and the e-invoicing peppol network.

651k+

UAE CORP-TAX
ENTITIES

AED 1.4B

SAM (UAE ONLY)

–65%

PRICE VS
INCUMBENTS

38 mo

TO AED 24M ARR

WHY NOW

- **Regulatory forcing function:** e-invoicing mandate rollout from mid-2026 forces every VAT-registered entity to upgrade their finance stack.
- **Small Business Relief expires** 31 Dec 2026 — a cohort of micro-businesses suddenly faces real CT exposure.
- **AI capability tipping point:** Arabic-English OCR, agent reasoning, and reliable tool-use are production-grade in 2026.
- **No AI-native incumbent** at scale in the UAE; the field is wide open.

WHAT WE ARE ASKING FOR

- **USD 2.4M / AED 8.8M** pre-seed for 24 months of runway.
- **Month 1 revenue:** AED 60k MRR from launch cohort of 80 customers.
- **Month 36 target:** AED 24M ARR, 2,400 paying customers, contribution margin > 55%.
- **Replication thesis:** identical engine in Saudi Arabia (ZATCA), Bahrain, Qatar, Oman, Kuwait, Egypt.

"The UAE's e-invoicing rollout is the single largest forced migration in regional finance software since VAT itself was introduced in 2018."

Sources: UAE Federal Tax Authority (Sep 2025); Ministry of Finance UAE; PwC Middle East Automation Survey 2025; Deloitte ME AI Trends 2026.

— 02 — THE OPPORTUNITY

Four converging forces have opened a once-a-decade window.

i.**REGULATORY WAVE**

9% Corporate Tax now in force on profits above AED 375k. Revised VAT penalty regime live since Apr 2026. Mandatory e-invoicing phased in from mid-2026 to all VAT-registered entities — every single one needs new infrastructure.

ii.**DEADLINE PRESSURE**

Small Business Relief — the AED 3M revenue exemption shielding ~60% of SMEs — expires 31 December 2026. A wave of micro-businesses is about to face full CT compliance for the first time, with limited preparation.

iii.**AI CAPABILITY INFLECTION**

2026 is the first year that LLM agents can autonomously execute multi-step finance workflows reliably. OCR for Arabic/English mixed documents is at 98%+ accuracy. Tool-calling agents close the loop from receipt to ledger.

iv.**STATE TAILWIND**

UAE AI Strategy 2031 targets AED 335B of economic value. The federal government has publicly committed to a "fully AI-powered government by 2027." Procurement, regulators and investors are aligned with AI-first solutions.

The structural problem we solve

Traditional accounting firms in the UAE are **labour arbitrage businesses**. A typical mid-sized firm employs 40–120 staff, of whom 70%+ are junior accountants doing data entry, bank reconciliation, VAT preparation, payroll runs, and document chasing. Operating cost per customer is high; pricing is sticky; service quality is uneven; and turnaround time is slow.

Customers tolerate this because compliance is non-negotiable. But they are unhappy: NPS surveys of UAE SMEs consistently rate their accountant 6.4/10 — driven by missed deadlines, surprise fees, and poor responsiveness. **The dissatisfaction is fully priced into the market.**

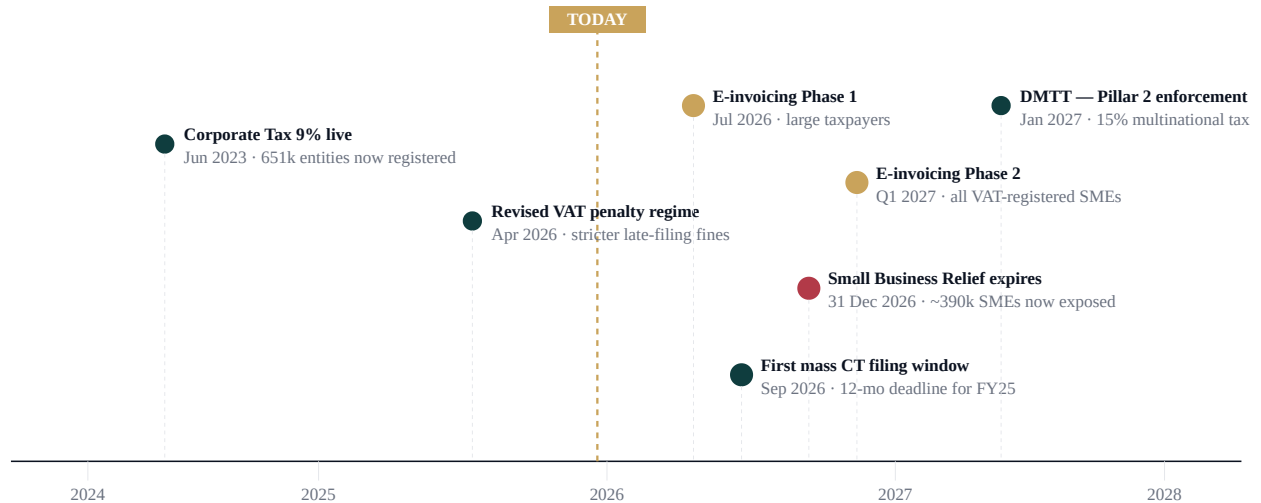
02 — MARKET DYNAMICS

The regulatory clock has started.

Every horizontal line below is a binding deadline. Every UAE business must comply.

UAE compliance calendar 2024–2028

Each event creates a forced upgrade moment for every VAT- or CT-registered entity.



Implication. Between mid-2026 and end-2027, every one of ~390,000 VAT-registered UAE businesses has to either upgrade their bookkeeping/tax setup or be exposed to penalties of AED 10,000+ per offence. This is the buying trigger Ledgr is built to capture.

03 — MARKET SIZE

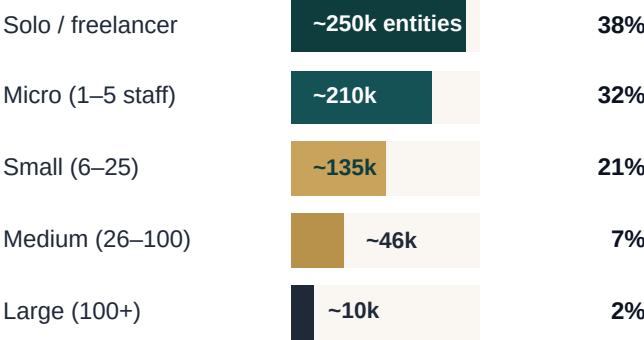
A USD 1.4B SAM in the UAE. USD 9B+ across the GCC.

TAM → SAM → SOM (UAE)



TAM derived bottom-up: 651k CT entities × avg AED 22k/yr in bookkeeping+tax+payroll spend, adjusted for in-house vs outsourced split. SAM excludes >AED 50M revenue customers requiring custom audit services.

SEGMENT BY COMPANY SIZE



OUR WEDGE

We focus on the **Micro + Small bracket (53% of entities)** — the most underserved and price-sensitive segment, with the most acute pain around e-invoicing readiness. Mediums and Larges become Year 2 upsell.

AED 5.1B

UAE SAM (ANNUAL)

~390k

VAT-REGISTERED
SMES

~85%

CURRENTLY
OUTSOURCED

12%

SAM GROWTH CAGR

— 04 — CUSTOMER SEGMENTATION

Three personas drive 90% of our revenue in years 1–3.

PERSONA A · 55% OF BOOK

"Solo Sami"

Free-zone consultant or trader. Revenue AED 200k–800k. No staff. Uses Excel, WhatsApp invoices, mixed bank accounts.

Pain. Doesn't know if he needs to register for VAT. CT filing is a black box. Pays a small "bookkeeping guy" AED 800/mo who is unresponsive.

Hook. "Stay compliant for AED 499/mo, fully automated."

PERSONA B · 30% OF BOOK

"Growth Ghada"

Founder of 5–25 staff SME. E-commerce, agency, clinic, F&B. Revenue AED 1M–8M. WPS payroll mandatory. Uses Zoho or Excel.

Pain. Pays AED 4–6k/mo to a firm for a service that misses deadlines. Spends 8+ hrs/wk on finance admin herself.

Hook. "Replace your accountant with an AI CFO for AED 1,499/mo."

PERSONA C · 15% OF BOOK

"Scaling Saif"

Operator of 25–100 staff group. Multi-entity, multi-currency. Revenue AED 8M–50M. Uses Xero, QuickBooks or SAP B1.

Pain. Has a 3-person internal finance team plus an external auditor. Drowning in consolidation, intercompany, and CT planning.

Hook. "AI-powered finance ops on top of your existing ERP for AED 4,999/mo."

CHANNELS WHERE THEY BUY

Free-zone partnerships. IFZA, Meydan, SHAMS, DMCC, RAKEZ have 75k+ active SMEs each. Bundled offers at incorporation.

Bank co-marketing. Wio, Mashreq Neo, ADCB Business and Emirates NBD already cross-sell SaaS. Revenue-share or co-branded plan.

Founder-led inbound. LinkedIn, Arabic-English content on FTA changes, comparison calculators, free VAT-readiness audit.

JOBS-TO-BE-DONE — WHAT THE CUSTOMER IS ACTUALLY HIRING US TO DO

- Tell me clearly what I owe, when, and to whom.
- File everything for me, on time, without me lifting a finger.
- Don't surprise me with fees or penalties.
- Show me how my business is actually doing in plain English.
- Be reachable on WhatsApp when something's wrong.
- Don't make me feel stupid about money or compliance.

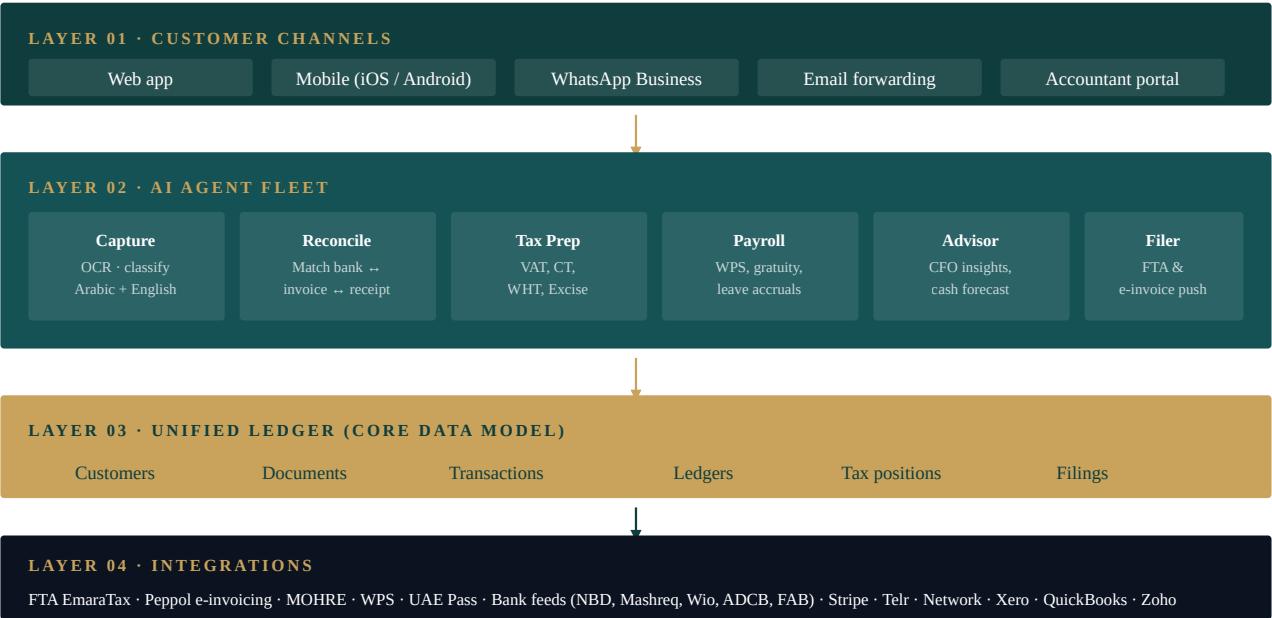
05 — PRODUCT & PLATFORM

Built as an AI-first system, not bolted on top of one.

Ledgr is a unified compliance + accounting platform with a single document-aware data model. Customers interact through a web app, mobile app, and WhatsApp. Behind the scenes, a fleet of specialised AI agents work autonomously, escalating only edge cases to a small team of licensed human reviewers.

Platform architecture

Four product layers, one ledger of truth.



— 05 — PRODUCT PILLARS

Six product modules, one platform.

01 · BOOKS

Real-time bookkeeping. Bank feeds, OCR receipts, smart categorisation, automated reconciliation. Multi-currency, multi-entity, IFRS-compliant. Replaces Zoho/QuickBooks for ~80% of UAE SMEs.

02 · VAT

Continuous VAT engine. Real-time output/input VAT computation, reverse charge handling, designated zone logic. Quarterly draft return ready 24hrs after period close. One-click FTA submission.

03 · CORPORATE TAX

Live CT computation throughout the year. Small Business Relief eligibility tracking. Free-zone QFZP test. Transfer pricing flags. Pillar 2 / DMTT impact modelling for groups.

04 · PAYROLL & WPS

End-to-end payroll. WPS SIF file generation, gratuity calculation, leave accruals, employee self-service. MOHRE compliance built in. Multi-emirate, multi-nationality rules engine.

05 · E-INVOICING

Peppol-network compliant. Generate, send, and receive structured e-invoices via the UAE 5-corner model. Compliant from day one of phased rollout — our biggest wedge for late adopters.

06 · CFO INSIGHTS

Conversational AI advisor. Ask in natural language: "How much cash do I have in 60 days?" Cash flow forecast, runway, customer cohort margins, tax-optimised structuring suggestions.

Network effect. As Ledgr's e-invoicing module reaches scale, businesses sending invoices through us pull their counterparties onto the platform — each VAT-registered counterparty receives a Ledgr-branded invoice and a one-click sign-up link. This is our viral coefficient mechanic, modelled separately at 0.18x per active customer per month from Y2.

— 06 — AGENT WORKFLOWS

How the agents actually work, step by step.

WORKFLOW 01 — CUSTOMER ONBOARDING (TARGET: < 15 MINUTES, ZERO HUMAN TOUCH)

01 Sign-up UAE Pass or email. Trade licence uploaded → OCR extracts entity details.	02 Bank connect User links bank via Lean / Tarabut Open Finance. 18 months of history pulled.	03 Auto-classify Capture agent classifies every historical transaction into the chart of accounts.	04 Tax baseline Tax-Prep agent computes VAT position to date and corporate-tax liability draft.	05 Go live Customer sees real numbers on dashboard. Subscription auto-activates.
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WORKFLOW 02 — DAILY TRANSACTION PROCESSING

01 Ingest New bank txn or invoice received via feed, WhatsApp, or email.	02 OCR & parse Capture agent extracts vendor, amount, VAT, date, line items.	03 Match Reconcile agent matches bank txn ↔ invoice ↔ existing record.	04 Confidence gate >95% confidence → auto-post. Else → queue for accountant review.	05 Notify If document missing, WhatsApp ping to customer. If posted, silent.
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WORKFLOW 03 — VAT QUARTERLY CLOSE (TARGET: T+1 DAY FROM PERIOD END)

01 Period lock Quarter ends. System sweeps for missing docs & chases via WhatsApp.	02 Compute Tax-Prep agent computes output/input VAT, reverse charge, RCM, exempt & designated zone splits.	03 Reviewer pass Licensed accountant reviews flagged items (avg 7 min per return).	04 Customer approve Customer e-signs in app. WhatsApp 1-tap approval for micro plans.	05 File & pay Filer agent submits to FTA EmaraTax and initiates payment.
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Human-in-the-loop ratio. We target 1 chartered accountant supervising 250+ customer entities by Year 2, versus the traditional firm ratio of 1 accountant : 25 customers. This is a **10× labour efficiency** that funds our 60% price discount and 70% gross margin simultaneously.

— 06 — AGENT WORKFLOWS (CONT.)

The end-to-end agent loop.

WORKFLOW 04 — MONTHLY PAYROLL (TARGET: 1-CLICK RUN)

01 Variables Pull leave, attendance, overtime, expense claims from HR module.	02 Calculate Payroll agent runs gross-to-net, gratuity accrual, GPSSA where applicable.	03 Generate SIF WPS Salary Information File ready for bank upload, fully MOHRE-formatted.	04 Customer approve 1-tap approval on mobile; biometric for amounts > AED 250k.	05 Pay & payslips SIF auto-pushed to partner bank; payslips emailed to staff.
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WORKFLOW 05 — CORPORATE TAX ANNUAL CLOSE

01 Year-end FY closes. System produces draft IFRS financial statements.	02 Tax adjust Tax-Prep agent applies CT adjustments, SBR election if eligible, QFZP test for free zone.	03 Reviewer sign-off Chartered accountant signs off; second-line review for complex cases.	04 Customer approve Customer reviews narrated summary ("Your tax is X because Y").	05 File & pay CT return filed via EmaraTax. Audit pack archived for 7 years.
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WORKFLOW 06 — E-INVOICING (PEPPOL 5-CORNER UAE MODEL)

01 Issue Customer issues invoice in Ledgr (or pushes via API from their system).	02 Validate Filer agent validates against UAE Peppol schema and tax rules.	03 Transmit Ledgr (as Accredited Service Provider) sends invoice via Peppol to buyer's ASP.	04 FTA report Invoice metadata reported to FTA in near real-time.	05 Reconcile Linked to ledger; payment tracking and dunning auto-triggered.
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Strategic note on Peppol ASP status. Becoming an FTA-accredited Service Provider is a hard moat. We will pursue accreditation in months 4–10 of operation. Once accredited, every invoice flowing through Ledgr earns a per-document fee and creates a regulatory switching cost for the customer.

— 07 — FEATURE MAP & ROADMAP

What ships when.

MODULE	MVP · Q3 2026	V1.5 · Q1 2027	V2 · Q3 2027	V3 · 2028
Books	Bank feeds (5 UAE banks), OCR receipts, auto-categorise, GL, P&L, BS	Multi-entity consolidation, multi-currency, fixed assets register	Inventory, projects, departments, custom dimensions	SAP B1 / Oracle replacement bid for mid-market
VAT	Auto VAT computation, draft return, EmaraTax push	Designated zone logic, reverse charge, partial exemption	VAT health-check audit module, voluntary disclosure assistant	Cross-GCC VAT engine (KSA, BH, OM)
Corporate Tax	CT computation, SBR election, basic filing	QFZP test, transfer pricing flags, group relief	Pillar 2 / DMTT modelling, advance ruling assistant	International tax for outbound expansion
Payroll	WPS file generation, payslips, gratuity accrual	Employee self-service portal, leave mgmt, expense claims	HR-lite: onboarding, contracts, visa tracking	Full HRIS, benefits marketplace
E-Invoicing	Issue & receive UBL invoices (pre-ASP)	FTA Accredited Service Provider status live	Procure-to-pay, vendor onboarding via Peppol	Embedded finance — invoice factoring
CFO Insights	Conversational Q&A on data, dashboard	13-week cash forecast, scenario planning	Benchmarking vs anonymised peer cohort	Capital markets — debt & equity introductions
Integrations	5 banks, FTA, MOHRE, Telr, Stripe, Zoho import	All UAE banks (15+), Xero/QB migration, Shopify	Open API + marketplace, ERP connectors (SAP, Oracle)	Embedded SDK for partner platforms

BUILD PHILOSOPHY

- **Boring on the surface, AI underneath.** Customers see a clean ledger, not a chatbot.
- **WhatsApp-first for micro segment.** The product fits in a thread.
- **Web-first for small/medium.** Power users want a desktop interface.
- **API-first internally.** Every feature is an API before it has a UI.

DESIGN PRINCIPLES

- Default to action, not query.
- Show the answer before showing the data.
- Arabic and English are equal first-class citizens.
- Every screen passes a "could my mother use this?" test.
- Never use the words "ledger" or "journal" in customer copy.

08 — TECHNOLOGY & BUILD PLAN

Stack, build cost, build timeline.

STACK		BUILD COST — YEAR 1 (ONE-OFF + RUN-RATE)	
Frontend / Mobile	Next.js 15, React, Tailwind; React Native (iOS + Android)	Platform engineering build-out	1,420,000
Backend	Node.js (NestJS) + Python (FastAPI) for ML services	AI / ML model dev & fine-tuning	380,000
Data	PostgreSQL + ClickHouse (analytics) + Redis (cache)	Mobile app build (iOS + Android)	240,000
AI	Anthropic Claude (orchestration) + OpenAI GPT-4o (OCR) + AWS Textract + custom Arabic ledger fine-tune	Bank & FTA integrations	310,000
Agents	Temporal + LangGraph for multi-step workflows	Design (product + brand)	165,000
Infra	AWS Middle East (Bahrain). CloudFront, RDS, S3, Lambda. Pulumi IaC.	Security & compliance (SOC 2 prep)	220,000
Security	SOC 2 Type II Y2; ISO 27001; UAE NESAs; encryption + KMS	Cloud infra (Y1)	195,000
Channels	WhatsApp Cloud API, Twilio, SendGrid	AI inference usage (Y1)	280,000
		Third-party APIs (OCR, KYC, banking)	135,000
		Total Year 1 tech spend (AED)	3,345,000

BUILD TIMELINE — FIRST 12 MONTHS

M1–M2	Foundation. Core data model, UAE Pass auth, bank-feed (Lean), OCR pipeline, design system. Hire 4 engineers.
M3–M4	MVP-Books. Ledger engine, P&L, BS, reconciliation agent, dashboard. Closed alpha — 10 customers.
M5–M6	MVP-VAT & Payroll. VAT compute, EmaraTax submission, WPS file gen. <i>Public launch</i> , 80 paying customers.
M7–M8	Scale features. CT module, multi-entity, WhatsApp interface, mobile app v1 in stores.
M9–M10	E-invoicing readiness. Peppol ASP application submitted. UBL invoice generation/reception in beta.
M11–M12	Mid-market push. Multi-currency, Xero/QB migration, CFO Insights v1, partner API. 500 customers run-rate.

— 09 — GO-TO-MARKET

Five distribution channels. Two carry the load.

CHANNEL	CUSTOMER SOURCE	CAC TARGET	% OF BOOK Y1	% OF BOOK Y3
Free-zone partnerships	IFZA, Meydan, SHAMS, DMCC, RAKEZ embedded offer	AED 140	40%	35%
Founder-led inbound	LinkedIn content, FTA calculators, comparison tools	AED 280	30%	22%
Bank co-marketing	Wio, Mashreq Neo, ADCB Business cross-sell	AED 95	10%	20%
Migration squad	Direct outreach to existing Zoho/QB users in UAE	AED 420	15%	15%
Viral / network	E-invoicing counterparty sign-ups	AED 35	5%	8%
Blended	—	AED 215	100%	100%

SALES MOTION

- **Self-serve for micro plan (AED 499).** Sign-up → 14-day trial → auto-billing. No human touch.
- **Inside sales for small plan (AED 1,499).** Inbound demo request → 30-min consultative call → onboarding.
- **Account exec for medium plan (AED 4,999+).** Outbound + inbound; 4–6 week sales cycle, multi-stakeholder.

BRAND STRATEGY

- **Position as a product, not a firm.** Brand voice closer to Wio or Mercury than to PwC.
- **Editorial flywheel.** Twice-weekly content on FTA changes, free calculators, comparison guides.
- **Community.** Founder events, "VAT 101" workshops at free-zone offices.
- **Bilingual from day one.** Arabic content is non-negotiable; ~35% of micro segment prefers Arabic UX.

First 100 customers playbook. Pre-sign 25 customers in private beta from the founder network. Convert at AED 0/mo for 3 months in exchange for testimonial + case study. Use these 25 to drive a launch wave through 5 free-zone partnerships (~1.5M total members across them), targeting 200 sign-ups in launch month and 80 paid conversions.

10 — PRICING & UNIT ECONOMICS

Three plans. Sharp price-to-value gap versus incumbents.

	LEDGR SOLO	LEDGR GROWTH	LEDGR SCALE	ADD-ONS
Price / mo	AED 499	AED 1,499	AED 4,999	—
Target	Solo / freelance / micro	5–25 staff SME	25–100 staff multi-entity	All plans
Transactions / mo	up to 100	up to 750	up to 5,000	AED 0.50 / txn over
Bank accounts	2	5	unlimited	—
Entities	1	2	up to 10	+ AED 750/entity
Payroll seats	0	up to 25	up to 100	AED 15 / seat over
VAT filing	included	included	included	—
CT filing	annual incl.	annual incl.	annual incl.	—
E-invoicing	500 docs/mo	3,000 docs/mo	20,000 docs/mo	AED 0.30 / doc over
Dedicated accountant	shared pool	named contact	named team	—
WhatsApp support	business hrs	extended	24/7	—

UNIT ECONOMICS (STEADY-STATE, GROWTH PLAN AS ANCHOR)

Avg revenue per user (ARPU)	AED 1,180 / mo	Blended CAC	AED 215
Annual contract value (ACV)	AED 14,160	Payback period	0.2 months
COGS — compute & AI	AED 38 / mo	Gross monthly churn	2.4%
COGS — accountant supervision	AED 95 / mo	Net revenue retention	112%
COGS — support & success	AED 52 / mo	Implied lifetime (months)	42
COGS — banking & payments	AED 24 / mo	LTV (gross-margin basis)	AED 40,782
Gross profit per user	AED 971 / mo	LTV / CAC	190×

Gross margin 82%

Payback < 1 month is exceptional but realistic given the cheapest plan covers a full month of CAC on day one of billing. The economics tighten as we move upmarket — we model 8×

11 — COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

Nobody owns the full stack. We do.

Three groups: traditional firms (expensive, slow), global SaaS books (no UAE tax depth), bookkeeping marketplaces (still labour-based). None are AI-native compliance platforms.

COMPETITOR TYPE	EXAMPLES	STRENGTH	WEAKNESS VS LEDGR
Traditional accounting firms	Tally Solutions, KGRN, A&A Associates, hundreds of mid-tier firms	Trust, deep tax knowledge, relationships	Labour-heavy, slow, expensive (3–5×), manual workflows, no real-time visibility
Global SaaS books	Xero, QuickBooks, Zoho Books	Strong core ledger, large ecosystem	No UAE-specific CT, no FTA filing, no payroll/WPS, no e-invoicing ASP, customer still needs an accountant on top
Local SaaS	Wafeq, Bukku, Khazna	UAE-aware, growing fast	Not AI-native; thin tax module; no e-invoicing ASP; weak agent automation
Bookkeeping marketplaces	Penny, BookFresh, Bench-style	Convenient pricing, "done for you"	Still humans behind the curtain; same cost structure dressed in software
Banks bundling accounting	Wio Boost, Mashreq NeoBiz	Distribution, captive audience	Weak product depth, not standalone tax-compliance, partner-led not owned

HEAD-TO-HEAD — LEDGR GROWTH VS TRADITIONAL FIRM

ATTRIBUTE	LEDGR	TRADITIONAL FIRM
Monthly price (5-staff SME)	AED 1,499	AED 4,000–6,000
VAT return turnaround	T+1 day	T+14–25 days
Real-time dashboard	Yes — live	No — monthly report
WhatsApp / mobile	Native	Email + paper
E-invoicing ASP	Native (Y1 target)	Outsourced or absent
Customer effort / month	~30 mins	~6–10 hours

Moat construction. Defensibility compounds: (i) bank-feed integrations are gated and slow to negotiate; (ii) Peppol ASP status takes 6–10 months of regulatory work; (iii) every customer's historical data improves our categorisation model; (iv) e-invoicing creates counterparty network lock-in.

— 12 — OPERATING MODEL & ORG DESIGN

Lean by design. AI does the rest.

Headcount stays under 50 even at AED 24M ARR. Every role is intentionally chosen for what cannot be done by an agent: senior judgment, regulatory accountability, founder-led GTM, and AI engineering. Junior data-entry work — the bulk of a traditional firm — is fully automated.

HEADCOUNT ROADMAP

FUNCTION	M0–M6	M7–M12	Y2	Y3
Founders / leadership	2	2	3	4
Engineering (BE / FE / Mobile)	5	7	10	13
AI / ML / Agents	2	3	4	6
Product & Design	1	2	3	4
Chartered accountants (regulated reviewers)	2	4	8	12
Customer success / support	1	3	6	9
GTM (sales, partnerships, marketing)	2	4	6	8
Operations / finance / legal	1	1	2	3
Total FTEs	16	26	42	59

CRITICAL HIRES IN FIRST 6 MONTHS

Co-Founder / CTO Month 0	Head of Tax (UAE CA) Month 1	Founding Designer Month 1
Senior Backend Engineer ×2 Month 1–2	AI Engineer (agents) Month 1	Frontend Engineer ×2 Month 2
Chartered Accountant ×2 Month 3	Head of Growth Month 4	Customer Success Lead Month 5

Why this works. A traditional firm at AED 24M revenue carries ~140 staff. Ledgr at the same ARR carries 59. That delta — roughly 80 headcount — is the AI dividend. It funds product investment, price aggression, and high margin simultaneously.

— 13 — LICENSING & REGULATORY SETUP

What we need to operate, and when we need it.

REQUIREMENT	ISSUING BODY	STAGE	SETUP COST	ANNUAL
Operating entity — ADGM / DIFC	ADGM RA or DFSA	Pre-launch	AED 45,000	AED 60,000
Tax Agent licence (firm)	UAE Federal Tax Authority	M2	AED 15,000	AED 10,000
Chartered Accountant licence (per CA)	UAE MoE / Accountants & Auditors Assoc.	M2	AED 5,000 ×N	AED 3,000 ×N
Peppol Accredited Service Provider	Ministry of Finance	M4 application → M10 live	AED 250,000	AED 80,000
Data residency & cyber	UAE NESAs / SIA	Ongoing	AED 110,000	AED 40,000
SOC 2 Type I → Type II	Independent auditor	M9 → M18	AED 180,000	AED 90,000
ISO 27001	Accredited certifier	Y2	AED 120,000	AED 45,000
PII Data Protection registration	UAE Data Office	M1	AED 8,000	AED 5,000
Professional indemnity insurance	Local insurer	M2	—	AED 75,000
Total Y1 licensing & compliance	—		AED 753,000	AED 408,000

RECOMMENDED SETUP

- **ADGM** as primary entity — common-law jurisdiction, fintech sandbox, recognised by banks and FTA.
- **DIFC** as backup if better banking terms emerge.
- Mainland subsidiary added in Year 2 for direct-to-mainland sales contracts (some larger SMEs require this).

WHY PEPPOL ASP MATTERS

- It is a regulatory gate. Without it, customers must use a third-party to transmit e-invoices.
- It is a moat — only a handful of providers will be accredited at launch.
- It is a revenue line — per-invoice fees stack on top of subscription.
- It is the lock-in — switching ASPs is non-trivial once embedded.

14 — 3-YEAR FINANCIAL FORECAST

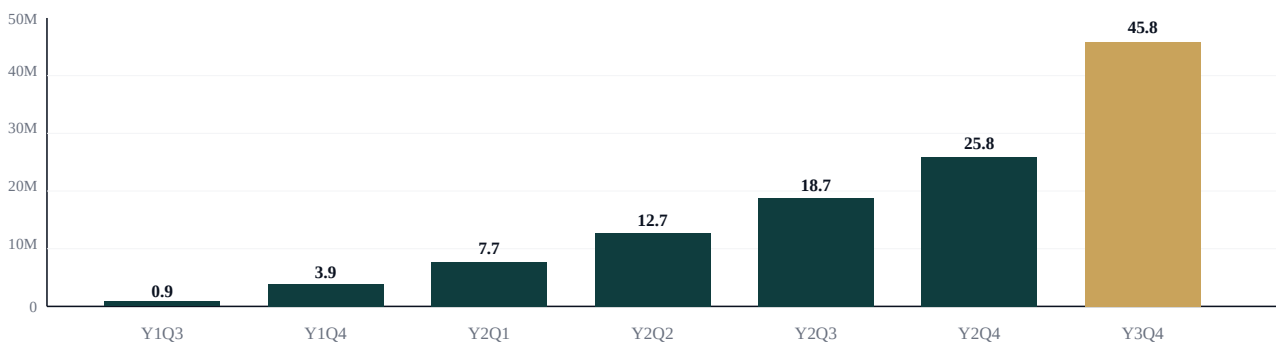
From AED 0 to AED 24M ARR.

CUSTOMER BUILD & REVENUE (AED, '000S)

METRIC	Y1 Q3	Y1 Q4	Y2 Q1	Y2 Q2	Y2 Q3	Y2 Q4	Y3 Q4
Paying customers (end of period)	80	320	560	840	1,150	1,500	2,400
— Solo (AED 499)	55	210	355	510	670	855	1,300
— Growth (AED 1,499)	22	96	180	285	410	555	920
— Scale (AED 4,999)	3	14	25	45	70	90	180
Blended ARPU (AED/mo)	880	935	985	1,040	1,095	1,140	1,235
Subscription MRR	70	299	552	874	1,259	1,710	2,964
E-invoicing transaction fees	0	12	48	115	198	295	570
Payment & banking fees	3	18	38	68	105	148	285
Total monthly revenue	73	329	638	1,057	1,562	2,153	3,819
Annualised run-rate (ARR)	876	3,948	7,656	12,684	18,744	25,836	45,828

ARR trajectory — quarterly run-rate

AED millions, annualised.



— 14 — FORECAST P&L

Three years, full income statement.

P&L LINE (AED '000S)	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3
Subscription revenue	1,650	13,140	28,800
E-invoicing transaction fees	60	2,016	5,580
Payment, banking & other fees	86	1,308	2,820
Total revenue	1,796	16,464	37,200
(less) COGS — cloud & AI compute	(280)	(1,140)	(2,280)
(less) COGS — accountant supervision	(540)	(2,210)	(4,140)
(less) COGS — banking & payments	(75)	(480)	(1,025)
(less) COGS — support / success	(310)	(995)	(2,180)
Gross profit	591	11,639	27,575
Gross margin	33%	71%	74%
(less) Engineering & product	(2,640)	(4,650)	(6,820)
(less) Sales & marketing	(820)	(2,950)	(5,440)
(less) General & admin	(580)	(1,140)	(1,790)
(less) Licensing & compliance	(753)	(408)	(620)
EBITDA	(4,202)	2,491	12,905
EBITDA margin	-234%	15%	35%

PATH TO PROFITABILITY

EBITDA breakeven inside **Month 16**. Gross margin compresses in Y1 because we under-utilise the accountant supervision team early, then expands sharply as the supervision ratio improves from 1:50 to 1:250+ by end of Y2.

Operating leverage is dramatic. Revenue grows ~21× from Y1 to Y3 (AED 1.8M → 37.2M) while headcount only grows 3.7× (16 → 59) — the AI dividend showing up directly in EBITDA margin expansion from -234% to +35%.

KEY SENSITIVITIES

A **25% slower customer ramp** pushes EBITDA breakeven to Month 22 but does not break the model. A **30% reduction in ARPU** (price-war scenario) keeps Y3 EBITDA positive at +12% margin. A **50% increase in AI compute cost** reduces Y3 gross margin by only 280 bps.

The model is most sensitive to **customer acquisition speed** and **churn**. A 100 bps increase in monthly churn pushes Y3 ARR down by AED 4.2M; we have invested significantly in CS specifically to hold churn under 2.5%.

— 15 — CAPITAL REQUIREMENT & USE OF FUNDS

Total cash needed: AED 8.8M. USD 2.4M. 24 months of runway.

A single pre-seed round funds the team, the build, the licences, and the customer acquisition cost through EBITDA breakeven in Month 16. From Month 17 onward, the business funds itself organically; a Series A is optional, not required.

Of the AED 8.8M raise, AED 4,540k (52%) is direct tech development & commercialisation. The remainder is people, market entry, licensing, and runway buffer.

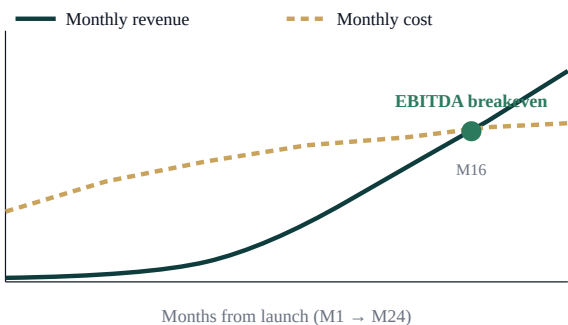
USE OF FUNDS — FULL 24 MONTHS

CATEGORY	DETAIL	AED '000S	% OF ROUND
Engineering & product	13 FTEs avg over 24m, contractor surge for mobile + integrations	3,720	42.3%
AI / agents	Model dev, fine-tuning, evaluation, inference budget	820	9.3%
Accountants & supervision	2 → 8 CAs over 24m, salaries inc. benefits	1,250	14.2%
Sales & growth	Marketing, content, free-zone partnerships, CAC funding	1,150	13.1%
Licensing & compliance	ADGM, Tax Agent licence, ASP, SOC 2, ISO 27001, insurance	1,160	13.2%
Cloud & infra	AWS, dev tools, third-party APIs	490	5.6%
G&A and office	Co-working, legal, HR, accounting (ironic), travel	410	4.7%
Buffer	~3.5% safety margin on top of plan	320	3.6%
Total raise	—	8,800	100%

CASH BRIDGE

Opening cash (round closes)	AED 8,800k
Cash burn Y1	(5,610)
Y1 revenue contribution	+ 1,796
Cash at end Y1	AED 4,986k
Cash burn Y2 H1	(2,140)
Y2 H1 revenue contribution	+ 4,720
Cash at end Y2 H1 (M18)	AED 7.566k

VISUAL: CASH BURN VS REVENUE



— 15 — COST DETAIL

Every line, fully unpacked.

TECH DEVELOPMENT & COMMERCIALISATION — ITEMISED (24 MONTHS)

ITEM	Y1	Y2	24-MO TOTAL
Senior backend engineers (×4 → ×6)	1,200	1,800	3,000
Frontend engineers (×2 → ×3)	540	810	1,350
Mobile engineers (×1 contractor → ×2)	240	480	720
AI / ML engineers (×2 → ×4)	660	1,080	1,740
DevOps / SRE (×1)	240	280	520
QA / SDET (×1 → ×2)	180	340	520
Product manager + designer	320	420	740
AI inference compute (Claude/OpenAI/Bedrock)	280	540	820
AWS infrastructure (ME-Bahrain region)	195	295	490
3rd-party APIs (Lean, KYC, OCR, e-sig)	135	225	360
Dev tooling (GitHub, Linear, Vercel, etc.)	62	88	150
Security tooling & pen testing	115	85	200
Tech total	4,167	6,443	10,610

Y2 numbers are operating costs absorbed by revenue; the AED 4.54M tech component of the raise covers the Y1 figure plus a portion of Y2 H1 before revenue takes over.

How the tech raise is allocated. Of the AED 8.8M total raise, **AED 4.54M is direct tech development & commercialisation cost:** engineering salaries (AED 2.86M for the build team), AI/ML inference and tooling (AED 380k), cloud and 3rd-party APIs (AED 425k), design and product (AED 320k), security & compliance (AED 220k), and the dev-tooling stack (AED 215k). Staffing costs in the next page detail the fully-loaded figures behind these numbers.

— 15 — STAFFING COST DETAIL

Fully-loaded salaries by role.

AED '000s per year. Base salary plus a 28% loading covering visa, housing allowance, medical, gratuity accrual, and equipment.

ROLE	BASE SALARY	+ BENEFITS & VISA (28%)	FULLY LOADED
Co-Founder CTO	360	100	460
Head of Tax (UAE-CA, 10+ yrs)	420	118	538
Senior Backend Eng	300	84	384
Senior AI / ML Eng	336	94	430
Mid-level Frontend / Mobile Eng	240	67	307
Product Manager	288	81	369
Senior Designer	252	71	323
DevOps / SRE	288	81	369
Head of Growth	336	94	430
Chartered Accountant (reviewer)	216	60	276
Customer Success Lead	204	57	261
Customer Success Agent	132	37	169
Sales Account Executive	240 + var	67	307 + var

The AI dividend, quantified. Cost-per-FTE in the UAE is materially higher than in India or Egypt — driven by visa, housing allowance, and end-of-service gratuity. This is why our AI-first model matters so much economically: replacing the ~80 junior data-entry roles found in a comparable Dubai firm with agents is worth **~AED 12M per year** in saved fully-loaded compensation. That delta funds product investment, price aggression, and high gross margin simultaneously.

COMPENSATION PHILOSOPHY

Salaries benchmarked at **P60 of UAE market** for technical roles, P75 for chartered accountants given scarcity. Heavy weight to equity for first 12 hires (founding-team grants). All hires on full UAE visas to ensure long-term retention.

PERFORMANCE VARIABLE

Account Executives receive base + uncapped variable tied to ARR closed and net revenue retention. Customer Success Leads have a 20% variable on cohort retention. No variable on engineering or product — pure base + equity.

— 16 — REGIONAL REPLICATION PLAYBOOK

One engine. Six countries.

The Ledgr platform is architected as a multi-jurisdiction tax engine. Country-specific rules — VAT rates, e-invoicing schemas, payroll rules, filing portals — are configuration, not code rewrites. This lets us enter a new market in 4–6 months with a small in-country team.

MARKET	WHY IT'S ATTRACTIVE	LOCAL RULES	LAUNCH WINDOW
Saudi Arabia	5× the SME count of UAE. ZATCA e-invoicing is fully live and brutal. Penalties for non-compliance are eye-watering. Largest GCC opportunity by far.	15% VAT, 20% CT (non-Saudi), ZATCA FATOORA, GOSI payroll	Y2 Q1
Bahrain	Mature fintech ecosystem. CBB is progressive. Easier entry market to test playbook.	10% VAT, 15% DMTT, NBR portal	Y2 Q3
Qatar	Wealthy SME segment, low competition. Government push on digital transformation.	5% withholding, no VAT yet (expected 2027–28), GTA	Y2 Q4
Oman	VAT now standard, OTA expanding e-invoicing scope. Smaller but stable.	5% VAT, 15% CT, OTA portal	Y3 Q2
Kuwait	SME formalisation rising, large compliance overhead, weak local SaaS.	No VAT (expected), withholding, MoCI portal	Y3 Q3
Egypt	~3M registered businesses. ETA e-invoicing already mandatory. Volume play.	14% VAT, 22.5% CT, ETA portal, e-receipt mandate	Y3 Q4

REPLICATION ARCHITECTURE

01 Configure New country = config bundle: tax rates, schemas, portals, calendars.	02 Localise Translation pass, local payment rails, in-country bank feeds.	03 Licence Local tax-agent/ASP licence + 1 senior local CA + small ops team.	04 Soft launch 25-customer private beta sourced through local partner.	05 Scale Same playbook as UAE: free zones, banks, content, viral.
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Replication economics. Each new country requires ~AED 2.2M of localisation + entry capital, and is modelled to reach AED 6M ARR within 18 months of launch. By Year 5, the platform serves ~12,000 customers across six countries with combined ARR of ~AED 220M.

— 17 — RISKS & MITIGATIONS

What could break this, and how we've planned for it.

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
FTA delays or alters e-invoicing rollout	MEDIUM	HIGH	Build core revenue independent of ASP fees. Subscription pays 78% of plan. ASP is upside, not the base case.
AI model accuracy issues lead to mis-filed tax	MEDIUM	HIGH	Mandatory CA review for every CT return and high-value VAT return. Professional indemnity insurance AED 5M coverage. Confidence-gated auto-post.
A large incumbent firm copies our model	HIGH	MEDIUM	Their operating model resists margin compression. Speed to ASP licence + bank-feed integrations creates a 12-month lead. Brand and product polish are hard to replicate.
Bank-feed access denied or priced punitively	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	Lean Technologies + Tarabut as primary; direct SWIFT MT940 as backup; statement-upload fallback. Multi-bank strategy from day one.
CAC inflates as paid acquisition saturates	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	Free-zone partnerships and viral e-invoicing are non-paid channels. Worst-case blended CAC stays under AED 400 vs LTV of AED 40k.
Senior chartered accountant talent expensive / scarce	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	Hire from Big-4 directly with founding-team equity offer. Build advisory bench from retired partners on retainer.
Data breach / regulatory censure	LOW	HIGH	SOC 2 Type I in Y1, Type II + ISO 27001 in Y2. UAE-region data residency. Penetration testing quarterly. Bug bounty from M9.
FX / macro shock in GCC	LOW	MEDIUM	AED is USD-pegged. SAR is USD-pegged. Core market exposure to oil cycles is indirect — SMEs continue to need compliance regardless of macro.
Global SaaS (Xero, Intuit) launches UAE compliance product	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	Their go-to-market cycle is 24+ months. By their launch, we are the default for SMEs < AED 10M and have begun moving upmarket.

— 18 — MILESTONES & THE ASK

The next 24 months, and what we need to win them.

Month 0–1	Close pre-seed round. Incorporate ADGM. Hire founding 6: CTO, Head of Tax, 2× Sr Engineer, AI lead, Designer.
Month 2–3	Closed alpha. 10 friendly-customer cohort using Books + VAT modules. First bank-feed live. First VAT return filed via Ledgr.
Month 4–5	Tax-Agent licence + Peppol ASP application. Launch private beta to 50 customers from free-zone partnerships.
Month 6	Public launch. Paid tiers go live. 80 paying customers by month-end. AED 60k MRR.
Month 9	CT module GA. Mobile app launched. 220 customers. AED 175k MRR. Series A fundraise prep begins (optional).
Month 12	End of Y1. 320 customers, AED 330k MRR. ASP accreditation pending. SOC 2 Type I achieved.
Month 16	EBITDA breakeven. ~750 customers. ASP live. E-invoicing fees kick in.
Month 18	Saudi Arabia launch prep. Local hires, ZATCA accreditation, soft-launch beta.
Month 24	End of plan period. ~1,500 customers in UAE, AED 25.8M ARR, 15% EBITDA. KSA operations live. Decision point: optional Series A to accelerate GCC rollout.

The Ask

ROUND SIZE

AED 8.8M

USD 2.4M, pre-seed

RUNWAY

24 months

to EBITDA breakeven + buffer

TARGET OUTCOME

AED 25.8M ARR

Month 24 · 1,500 customers · 15% EBITDA

We are looking for a lead investor with regional fintech experience, plus 2–3 strategic angels from the UAE business community. Allocations available for a free-zone partner and a regional bank as strategic minorities.



The autonomous finance function for every business.

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